

Julien Crésus-Ashton

SENIOR INTERACTION DESIGNER

Interaction designer with eight years in UK government and consumer apps. At the moment I'm designing HMRC's Council Tax challenge service for Wales, in Welsh and English, as a coded GOV.UK prototype. I like to get something rough in front of users early and change it when they get stuck. SC cleared.

EXPERIENCE

Cognizant Nov 2023 – Present

Senior Interaction Designer

- Led interaction design for HMRC's Welsh Council Tax service across all 22 Welsh local authorities, mapping complex policy logic into navigable user flows across discovery and alpha. Delivered accessible, GDS-compliant journeys.
- Designed a DEFRA/APHA workforce planning tool built on PowerBI, supporting planners across multiple Natural England reserves. Made the design decisions within Microsoft Fluent constraints through to handoff.
- Set the standard for personas, interaction models and service flows to GDS requirements, and made WCAG 2.2 compliance a team-wide expectation.
- Coached other designers on GDS standards and coded prototyping in HTML/CSS, bringing the team closer to the medium.

DAM Digital Apr 2022 – Nov 2023

Senior UX/UI Designer

- Led UX strategy across up to 3 concurrent client engagements including McArthurGlen and Crisis, owning the full design process from discovery through to handoff.
- Ran regular design reviews with clients and turned stakeholder feedback into design decisions grounded in user needs.
- Owned accessibility and design system standards across all concurrent projects, keeping them consistent.
- Coached a user researcher to independently produce production-ready Figma prototypes, upskilling their design craft and improving team throughput.

Methods Feb 2019 – Apr 2022

UX Designer

- Designed for government programmes including Every Mind Matters, National Funding Formula and Ministry of Defence, working to GDS standards across discovery, alpha and beta.
- Led cross-functional workshops with research, product and engineering, setting the design direction and ensuring decisions were grounded in user evidence before moving to build.
- Built research-informed prototypes in Figma and coded prototypes using React and the GOV.UK Design System, enabling faster collaboration with researchers and stakeholders than static tools allowed.

Société Générale Design Sep 2017 – Dec 2018

UX/UI Designer Trainee

- Designed interaction models for trading platforms and internal financial tools in low- and high-fidelity using Adobe XD and Sketch, shipping interface updates to internal trading systems used daily by the trading floor.
- Led co-creation sessions with traders, product owners and engineers to validate concepts early and reduce costly rework downstream.

SKILLS

- GDS Design System
- WCAG 2.2 accessibility
- Coded prototyping (HTML, CSS, React)
- Conditional routing and policy logic
- Bilingual Welsh and English services
- Service and journey mapping
- Workshop and design critique facilitation
- Figma, Sketch, Adobe XD
- Working with research and engineering

EDUCATION

- MSc UX Design**
Kingston University, London
2018 · Thesis: WebVR app for autism awareness, exploring immersive environments as a medium for inclusive design and empathy-building.
- BA Web Design**
Epitech Digital, Paris
2016

LANGUAGES

- French (*Native*)
- English (*Bilingual*)
- German (*Basic*)